Project Timeline

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

Two timelines for the same deliverable set: the factual solo build and an illustrative five-person organizational plan, led by the effort comparison, not the calendar.

The first is the retrospective record of a solo, AI-accelerated build, reconstructed from a dated process journal. The second estimates how a five-person L&D team might schedule the same scope with conventional methods; it is a simple exemplar, since organizations vary widely in workflow and staffing, so treat the five-person structure as one illustration rather than a template. The comparison is not an argument for replacing teams with AI; it is a demonstration of what AI-augmented development compresses, and what it does not.

The meaningful figure is roughly 150–160 focused hours against a ~735-hour industry baseline for comparable Level-3 e-learning, a 4.6–4.9× reduction. The eight-week calendar span overstates the working time: the early phases were part-time, and illness plus a physical injury near the start cost roughly two to three weeks of calendar time without adding to the hours.

EFFORT COMPARISON · THE HEADLINE

Focused solo effort ≈150-160 hrs

Focused solo effort, AI-accelerated

Conventional baseline ≈735 hrs

Chapman Alliance (2010) baseline for comparable Level-3 e-learning

4.6–4.9×

reduction in effort. Calendar for context only: ≈8 weeks solo vs 24–33 weeks organizational; the calendar span overstates working time and is not the compression figure.

DUAL-TRACK GANTT

SWIMLANE 1 · SOLO BUILD (≈8 WEEKS)

W1 5 10 15 20 25 30

Phase 0 · Research
Week 1

Research-corpus assembly: seven primary sources cataloged with extraction guidance, plus reference videos matched to structured transcripts. Mar 30

Phase 0.5 · Planning
Week 2

Production-plan overhaul (30 pages), eight components across six phases, the six-phase build sequence, QA methodology defined (Hardman AI Evals), system prompt aligned. Apr 7

Phase 1 · Needs Analysis
Weeks 2–3

Components 1 and 2A–2C: executive problem statement, market-level capability gap analysis, evidence-based learner persona, and the action map with its interactive JSX diagram. Full citation verification. Apr 10–14

Phase 2 · Design
Weeks 3–4

Program overview (17 performance objectives), the learning-architecture diagram, the platform architecture decision document and design system, six high-fidelity mockups, five component specs, and six triple-validated JSON data files. Apr 18–21

Phase 3 · Content + Build
Weeks 4–6

Four module documents (37 sections) and the custom platform: Vite + React + TypeScript, Tailwind, Recharts, 12 practice activities, 16 knowledge checks, the pre/post assessment, the analytics dashboard, three-mode navigation (later consolidated into the two-mode learner/portfolio system), and dark mode. Deployed to Cloudflare Pages. Apr 25–May 9

Phase 4 · Evaluation
Weeks 7–8

Kirkpatrick Levels 1–4 evaluation designs, a multi-module QA audit and remediation, and the Component 7 project-management artifacts. May 16–19

SWIMLANE 2 · ORGANIZATIONAL DEPLOYMENT (24–33 WEEKS)

W1 5 10 15 20 25 30

Needs Analysis
3–4 weeks

Research synthesis, stakeholder interviews, learner-persona development, gap analysis. Gated on SME availability, stakeholder scheduling, and data access.

Design
4–5 weeks

Action map, program structure, performance objectives, design system, and component specifications, including a 1–2 week stakeholder design-review and approval cycle within the phase.

Content Development
6–8 weeks

Module authoring (4 modules, 37 sections), knowledge-check and assessment items, data-file creation and validation, and 2–3 SME content-review rounds per module.

Platform Build
8–10 weeks

Custom React platform: 12 interactive components, data dashboards, analytics panel, responsive design, dark mode, three-mode navigation (later consolidated to two modes), and QA cycles. Runs parallel with content development for the first ~4 weeks.

Integration + QA
3–4 weeks

Content integration, cross-module testing, accessibility review, browser compatibility, a near-final stakeholder review, and bug fixes and polish.

Evaluation Design
2–3 weeks

Level 1–4 evaluation instruments, the ROI model, and administration protocols. Can partially overlap the Integration + QA phase.

Launch Prep
2–3 weeks

Deployment to hosting, manager orientation materials, learner communication, pilot-group selection, and baseline data collection for the Level-4 KPIs.

NEEDS ANALYSIS · DESIGN · CONTENT & BUILD · INTEGRATION & QA · EVALUATION · LAUNCH PREP

Both tracks run the same lifecycle; the solo build merges and folds phases (compression, not skipped steps), and the organizational schedule is illustrative.

WHERE THE COMPRESSION COMES FROM

Four factors account for most of the difference. Approval and review cycles were eliminated: the designer and the decision-maker were the same person, so there were no phase gates. Subject-matter expertise was in-house: AI literacy was the topic of my Master's degree, so the solo build also filled the SME role a team assigns to a separate person, with no availability or review-round dependency. AI-accelerated code generation compressed the single largest workstream: the AI-assisted build took two to three weeks of active development, where a corporate build of the same platform would run considerably longer, largely because of the additional corporate audits and review gates it would have to pass. And context continuity replaced the meetings and handoffs a distributed team needs: the process journal and system prompt carried all project context.

WHAT THE TEAM TIMELINE BUYS

A team produces things a solo build cannot: multiple perspectives that challenge design decisions, distributed risk (the solo build lost roughly two to three weeks to illness and injury with no one to absorb it), and the stakeholder alignment that phase-gate approvals create. The practical synthesis is a hybrid: use AI to compress implementation and documentation while preserving human-led analysis, design, and review.